



TEN MINUTES ON STAGE

SIX ROLES · EVERYBODY SPEAKS · NOBODY RUNS OVER

1 WHO DOES WHAT

Write a real name in the last column.

1 THE OPENER	0:00 – 0:40	Name the person and ask the big question. No biography yet.	<i>name</i>
2 THE STORY-TELLER	0:40 – 2:40	Five or six moments of the life, in order, all in the Past Simple, all with years.	<i>name</i>
3 THE EVIDENCE-GIVER	2:40 – 5:00	Your three criteria, and one thing Elizabeth did for each one. Year every time.	<i>name</i>
4 THE OTHER SIDE	5:00 – 6:30	What was <i>not</i> great. One or two real examples from the greatness test.	<i>name</i>
5 THE CLOSER	6:30 – 8:00	Your team's answer to WHAT MAKES A GREAT PERSON, and where Elizabeth lands on it.	<i>name</i>
6 THE QUESTION-TAKER	8:00 – 10:00	Take questions from the room. You may ask the rest of the team to help.	<i>name</i>

2 REHEARSAL CHECKLIST

One student holds this and ticks during the run.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Every member of the team speaks. | ☐ Three criteria, three pieces of evidence, in that order. |
| ☐ Nobody speaks for longer than two and a half minutes. | ☐ At least one honest point against your own person. |
| ☐ The big question is asked in the first minute. | ☐ The last sentence answers the big question directly. |
| ☐ Every date is said out loud, not only shown. | ☐ You finish inside ten minutes. |
| ☐ Every fact about the past is in the Past Simple. | ☐ You look at the room, not at the paper. |

3 THE FIX LIST

Three things. Three.

AFTER REHEARSAL 1 – THREE THINGS WE CHANGE (NOT FOUR)



SENTENCE FRAMES – STEAL THESE

OPENING

- Our person is Elizabeth the First, Queen of England from 1558 to 1603.
- Before we begin, one question: what makes a person great?
- Today we will give you our answer, and three pieces of evidence.

TELLING THE STORY (PAST SIMPLE)

- She was born in 1533 at Greenwich Palace.
- In 1554 her sister sent her to the Tower of London.
- She became queen in 1558, when she was twenty-five.
- She did not marry, and she kept the power herself.

GIVING EVIDENCE

- Our first criterion is courage. In 1588 she ...
- This shows that ...
- We chose this criterion because ...

THE OTHER SIDE

- But not everything was great. In 1569 ...
- We have to say honestly that ...
- A great person is not a perfect person, and here is why that matters.

CLOSING

- So our answer is: a person is great when ...
- Elizabeth meets two of our three criteria. The third one is harder.
- Thank you. We are ready for your questions.

TAKING QUESTIONS

- That is a good question. Can I check – do you mean ...?
- I am not sure about the year. Maria, do you remember?
- We did not find that in our text, so I cannot answer it today.

THE ONE RULE ABOUT THE PAST SIMPLE ON STAGE

Everything that happened before today is Past Simple: *she was, she became, she did not marry, did she marry?* Everything you think *now* is present: *we think, this shows, our answer is*. Mixing the two is the single mistake the room will hear.

WHAT A TEN-MINUTE TALK IS NOT

It is not a Wikipedia page read out loud. The story of the life is two minutes of the ten. The other eight are your answer to the question, and the evidence for it.